



Monthly Newsletter

# TOOLS FOR THE TOUGH DAYS

Here for the tough days, and the good ones too.



## Tough Days Conversations

A practical note for people who keep work moving

| Edition | Date           | Topic   |
|---------|----------------|---------|
| [01]    | September 2026 | Burnout |

## **Welcome to the Tough Days Project Newsletter. I am glad you are here.**

Thank you for subscribing. Taking that first step is never easy, so you should be proud of yourself.

This newsletter is here to give you tips and conversation starters to support your wellbeing, month by month.

Before I became a Psychologist, I spent 20 years in manufacturing, and that time shaped who I am. I saw first hand how we all just kept pushing through: ignoring our own burnout, dealing with difficult bosses or coworkers, financial stress, and staying strong for our children and partners no matter what.

Since then, as a Psychologist, I've noticed we mostly only ask for help once things get too hard, or once we're given an ultimatum, even while telling everyone around us it's okay to talk to us. That's exactly why Tools exists: for people who aren't ready to talk to someone else, but still want the option to work through things themselves. I'll always encourage you to find someone to talk to when things are really tough, but Tools is there for everything in between.

At the centre of it is checking in regularly with the mood slider, so your dashboard shows you what's working and what isn't. From there you can work through the resources at your own pace, one small step at a time, and set your own preferences for when and how often you hear from us. The most important part is becoming personally aware on your journey to wellbeing.

I look forward to chatting with you again in a month.

Nic Marcon

Director/Principal Psychologist

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## **Tough Days Conversation**

If you've spent years on the tools or on the road, maybe managing a team, or ongoing deadlines, you have no doubt felt burned out many times. But somehow over time we started treating burnout like we are failing, like there's something wrong with us if we feel that we can't keep going. We obviously keep going, because our families, our coworkers rely on us.

A study recently looked at more than 50k of workers across 35 countries, and found that 78% of what causes burnout comes from how work is set up, not from the person doing it. For example, long hours, isolation, unpredictable loads, unrealistic deadlines, conflict with bosses and coworkers ect.

If you are experiencing this, know that you are not weak or failing. Burnout is a normal response when the body is under a lot of strain for a long time. It's like if you are running flat out, your muscles will eventually give out because the body can't keep going indefinitely.

## Try this:

Choose one small action that fits the next shift, route, job, or service. Keep it simple enough to use on a busy day.

- ☐ **Before work** — Give yourself 5 minutes to yourself
- ☐ **During the shift** — Focus on the most pressing job, the others can wait
- ☐ **Before heading home** — Put on your favourite music and drive a different way home

These small things can make a huge difference in your life if you consistently do these.

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### Quote

*"In the construction trade, admitting you're running on empty can feel like failure. But feeling stressed or burnt out are simply signs you've been carrying too much for too long."*

Lifeline chair Steve Moylan

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## Resource spotlight

**Resource:** Protecting Yourself from Burnout (BRN-P03)

**Why it is worth a look:** Prevention is always better than a cure.



## Protecting Yourself from Burnout Before It Takes Hold

How to recognise the warning signs early and build genuine resilience

The best time to address burnout is before it fully arrives. Most people who experience burnout can look back and identify a point — often months earlier — where they noticed something was off but kept going anyway. Learning to recognise the early warning signs and respond to them before the depletion becomes profound is one of the most valuable investments you can make in your long-term health.

### Knowing Your Personal Warning Signs

Burnout has early warning signals that are unique to each person. Some common early signals include:

- Losing interest or enthusiasm for work that you normally find meaningful
- Feeling increasingly irritable or impatient in ways that are not like you
- Starting to dread specific days, meetings, or tasks
- Noticing that you are working longer but feeling less productive
- Sleep changing — either sleeping more than usual or struggling to sleep
- Small things starting to feel disproportionately hard
- A growing sense of "what's the point"

### Building Recovery Into Your Life — Not Just Your Schedule

The most effective protection against burnout is recovering more genuinely. This means:

To read more:

**How to find it:** Go to [Tools Website](#) and signup for 14 days free and get access to all of the resources, plus the notifications.

Getting support early can make a tough situation easier to handle. That is why we built Tools for the Tough Days. You can monitor your mood daily, get regular notification to help you change one thing at a time. It's free for 14 days, so you have nothing to loose.

[www.toolsforthetoughdays.com.au](http://www.toolsforthetoughdays.com.au)

Thanks for making time for this issue. Take what is useful, pass along what could help a mate, and look out for the next one.

Team Tough Days